

Chapter

Rise of Dictatorships

1. What is meant by 'Fascism'? Why did the Italians feel that they had been deceived by the Treaty of Versailles?

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2. How did the failure of the League of Nations lead to the rise of dictatorship?

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3. With reference to Nazism, answer the following questions:

(i) What were the aims of Nazism ?

(ii) How did Hitler establish a Totalitarian State in Germany?

(iii) State two similarities between the causes that led to the rise of Fascism and Nazism?

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4. (i) Identify the leader in the picture. How did he establish a totalitarian state in his country?



(ii) State three factors that led to the rise of Nazism.

(iii) State four similarities between the ideologies of Nazism and Fascism.

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5. On which side did Italy fight in the First World War ?

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Solution

1.

Ans: Fascism was a highly nationalistic, anti-communist and anti-democratic movement. It promoted dictatorship, where all power was concentrated in one leader and opposition was not tolerated.

The Italians felt deceived by the Treaty of Versailles because, despite joining the Allies in World War I with hopes of gaining territories from Turkey and Germany, they received only Southern Tyrol, Trentino and parts of Dalmatia. They did not get the German or Turkish colonies they had been promised.

2.

Ans: The League of Nations failed because it lacked real enforcement power and could not prevent aggression by major nations. As a result, dictatorships rose in countries like Germany, Italy and Japan. It was eventually replaced by the United Nations in 1945, which aimed to maintain international peace and security.

3.

Ans:

(i) Aims of Nazism:

- (a) To uphold the racial superiority of Germans and spread hatred against Jews.
- (b) To glorify extreme nationalism and place the nation above all else.
- (c) To establish a one-party dictatorship under a powerful leader.
- (d) To reject democracy and international peace efforts.
- (e) To use force, violence and aggression to achieve national goals.
- (f) To promote war as a means of expanding national interests.

(ii) How Hitler established a Totalitarian State:

(a) Elimination of Opposition: After becoming Chancellor in 1933, Hitler passed the Enabling Act, giving him dictatorial powers. All parties except the Nazi Party were banned, and opponents were arrested or eliminated.

(b) Control of Media and Propaganda: Hitler and his Propaganda Minister, Joseph Goebbels, controlled newspapers, radio, films and public events to spread Nazi ideology and secure loyalty to Hitler.

(iii) Two similarities between the causes of Fascism and Nazism:

(a) Both arose due to economic hardships and unemployment following World War I.

(b) Both movements rejected democracy and supported dictatorship, extreme nationalism and militarism.

4.

Ans:

(i) Leader in the picture: Adolf Hitler.

He established a totalitarian state by eliminating all political opposition, passing the Enabling Act to gain dictatorial powers, banning rival parties, and using fear, propaganda, and intimidation to control the population.

(ii) Three factors that led to the rise of Nazism:

(a) The Treaty of Versailles and the national humiliation it caused.

(b) Fear of the spread of Communism.

(c) The severe economic crisis in Germany after World War I.

(iii) Two similarities between the ideologies of Nazism and Fascism:

(a) Both believed in totalitarian rule where absolute power rested in the hands of a single leader.

(b) Both rejected democracy and promoted aggressive nationalism and militarism.

5.

Ans: Italy fought on the side of the **Allies (Britain and France)** in 1915.